and children passengers were murdered. An accomplice of the attackers often travelled in an attacked train and pulled the communication cord at the spot where the ambush was laid. As a result, train crews refused to work trains across the border.

Despite the formation of the military Punjab Boundary Force—since disbanded—whose duties primarily included protection of running trains and station staff on both sides of the boundary, attacks on trains persisted, until finally no train could be run in the boundary area without a military escort.

Eventually, the whole of the Punjab and the surrounding areas became embroiled, and the mass movements of refugees to and from India began. Many hundreds of railway employees left their posts and fled with their families. To complicate matters further, many officers on both sides of the boundary were new to their jobs; Muslims had moved from India to Pakistan, and Hindus from western Punjab to India. Their lack of local knowledge was in many cases a serious handicap to efficient working.

In the second week of September, the disturbances spread from the Punjab to certain parts of the United Provinces, affecting communication between Delhi and the ports. The GIPR and BB&CI Railway terminated their services to the north-east at Muttra, and the BB&CI Railway metre gauge services in and out of Delhi were suspended.

Even when the country has settled down again, the task ahead of the railways will be very great. Their chief difficulties will be to settle in and train new staff, sort out everything, build up balances of stocks of fuel and other materials, and overtake arrears of maintenance, that have accumulated to an alarming extent. [127]

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[122] M.K. Gandhi, *Third Class in Indian Railways* (Gandhi Publications League, Bhadrakali, Lahore, circa 1940)

[123] N.P. Shankaranarayana Rao, *Ashfaqulla Khan: The Immortal Revolutionary*, Republic Day Feature, Press Information Bureau, Government of India, 2000

[124] Article by former general manager, North-east Frontier Railway, BMS Bisht, dated 19 January 2010, originally published on the website of the Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS). Now on Indian Railway Fans' Club Association, https://www.irfca.org/articles/ina_railways.html

[125] Teesta Setalvad, *Beyond Doubt: A Dossier on Gandhi's Assassination*, Tulika Books, Sep 2, 2015

[126] Taylor C. Sherman, William Gould, Sarah Ansari, 'Performing Peace,' *Subjects to Citizens* , Cambridge University Press, p.81, and news reports

[127] *The Railway Gazette* , (Oct 3, 1947), p.390. Also reproduced on IRFCA website. http://www.irfca.org/docs/history/railway-gazette-partition-1947.html